INTRODUCTION

The Indian Census is a credible source of statistical information on different characteristics of the citizens since 1872. This was conducted at different points of time in different parts of the country. It was in 1881 that a Census was taken for the entire country simultaneously. Since then, Census has been conducted every ten years, without a break. The Census provides a snapshot of the country's population and housing at a given point of time. The Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner, India, under the Union Ministry of Home Affairs is the ***nodal authority*** for conducting decennial Census in the country. Census 2011 is the 15th National Census of the country since 1872 and the 7th after Independence.

The Indian Censuses have throughout evoked interest worldwide but have become of greater interest since 2001 when the country population crossed one billion marks. Taking count of the large size of the population, especially when it is continuing to grow made 2011 Census another challenge. Like in the past censuses, the census organisation undertook publicity by various means to create awareness amongst the public for participating in the Census.

Census provides detailed and authentic information on demography, economic activity, literacy and education, housing & household amenities, urbanisation, fertility and mortality, Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, language, religion, migration, disability and many other socio-cultural and demographic data. This information helps the Central and State Governments in planning and formulation of various policies. Besides, the delimitation or reservation of constituencies—Parliamentary/Assembly/Panchayats and other local bodies—are also based on demographic data.

According to ***Article 246*** of the Constitution of India, population Census is a Union Subject. But, the State Governments provide administrative support in conducting the Census process.

The Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner, headed by the Registrar General and Census Commissioner, plans and implements Census. There are field offices, headed by Directors of Census Operations,